

Shoshanat Ya'akov

407a

Version 1

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Arr. Stuart Izon

Shoshanat Ya'akov is taken from the final lines of the acrostic piyut Asher Heni, which was composed to extend the blessing after the reading of Megillat Esther. It is of unknown authorship, and likely dates back to the 5th century, though some have ascribed it to the Men of the Great Assembly. The comparison of the Jewish people to a lily echoes the language of Song of Songs, however it is also an unambiguous reference to the city of Shushan, borrowing the words from Esther chapter 8: "The city of Shushan rejoiced and celebrated."

This melody is attributed to the Bobov composer Rabbi Azriel Mandelbaum, who was murdered in the Holocaust. As there is no extant manuscript or authoritative recording, it is unclear how the words are meant to fit to the melody. Additionally, there are a number of textual variants to Shoshanat Yaakov, and it isn't obvious which one Mandelbaum intended. In this arrangement I have included the lines "Cursed be the wicked; blessed be all the righteous", which do not appear in all versions. Excluding these is presumably the reason why when I heard this melody sung in the UK, the words "v'gam charvona" were repeated an inordinate number of times, which is rather incongruous for such a minor character from the Megilla.

Moderato

Chazzan

mf
Sho - sha-nat ya - a - kov tza - ha - la v' - sa - mei - cha__ bi - ro - tam ya - chad t' -

Melody Alto

mp
Dum dum dum dum dum dum dum da da da

Tenor Bass

C.

1. chei - let mor - d' - chai 2. chei - let mor - d' - chai

M A

Ah Ah t' - shu - a - tam t' - shu - a - tam

T B

7

M
A

8

ha - yi - ta la - ne-tzach t' - shu - a - tam t' - shu - a - tam ha - yi - ta la - ne-tzach t' -

T
B

10

M
A

8

-shu-a-tam t' - shu-a-tam ha - yi - ta la - ne-tzach v' - tik - va - tam b' - chol dor va - dor

T
B

14

C.

8

1.

l' - ho - di - a l' - ho - di - a

M
A

8

l' - ho - di - a l' - ho di - a

T
B

18

C.

8

2.

di - a she - kol ko - ve - cha lo ye - vo - shu v' - lo yi - ka - l' - mu la - ne - tzach she

M
A

8

di - a Ah la - ne - tzach

T
B

21

C.

M
A

T
B

24

C.

M
A

T
B

27

M
A

T
B

31

M
A

T
B

35

C. a - ru - ra ze - resh e - shet_ maf - chi - di b' - ru - cha es - ter

M
A Ah _____ maf - chi - di Ah _____

T
B _____

38

C. m' - gi - na_ ba - a - di a - ru - rim kol ha - r' - sha - im

M
A _____ ba - a - di Ah _____

T
B _____

40 *rit.*

C. b' - ru - chim kol ha - tza - di - kim v' - gam char - vo - na za - chor_ la - tov

M
A _____ tza - di - kim v' - gam char - vo - na za - chor_ la - tov

T
B _____